

TSANGAI BUSINESS GROWTH SERIES · #03

The AI Opportunity Finder

Three simple questions that reveal exactly where AI will pay off in your business — and where it will just waste your money.

WHO IT'S FOR

Owners who know AI matters but don't know where to start

TIME REQUIRED

15 minutes

WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Your top 3 AI opportunities, ranked by payoff and effort

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The best AI opportunity isn't the flashiest one. It's the most boring one.

This guide gives you a three-question filter to test any task in your business. Pass the filter, and AI will crush it. Fail it, and no tool on earth will help.

Owners show me shiny AI demos every week. I show them their inbox. The wins are never where the hype is — they're in the boring, repeated, rules-based work you've done so long you've stopped seeing it. This filter makes the invisible obvious.

— Ray, TsangAI Consulting

WHY THIS MATTERS

3 Qs

Three questions separate real AI wins from expensive experiments

1st try

Your first automation sets your belief — pick one that can't miss

Top 3

You only need three ranked opportunities, not thirty ideas

THE ONE IDEA

The 3-Question Filter: Repeated? Rules? Real hours?

A task is a great AI opportunity when you can answer yes three times: Is it **repeated** weekly or daily? Does it follow **rules** you could explain to a new hire? Does it eat **real hours** — at least 2 per week?

Example: "Answering the same 10 customer questions by email" — repeated daily, follows rules, eats 4 hours a week. Perfect. "Deciding who to hire next" — not repeated, no fixed rules. Keep that one human.

YOUR 10-MINUTE QUICK WIN

- ☐ Write down the 5 tasks you or your team repeat most each week
- ☐ Run each through the 3-Question Filter on page 4
- ☐ Score the ones that pass on payoff and effort
- ☐ Circle your #1 — you now know exactly where to start with AI

Five steps to your ranked shortlist

1 Dump every repeated task

Walk through a normal week in your head: Monday morning to Friday night. Write down every task that happens more than once. Include your team's tasks too.

Do this: List 8–12 tasks in the worksheet on page 4. More is fine.

2 Apply the 3-Question Filter

For each task ask: Repeated often? Follows rules? Eats 2+ hours a week? Cross out anything with less than three yeses.

Do this: Check the R / R / H boxes in the worksheet. Three checks = keeper.

3 Score payoff and effort

Payoff: how many hours or dollars it saves per week (1–5). Effort: how hard it is to set up (1 = a prompt, 5 = a developer). You want high payoff, low effort.

Do this: Fill both columns. Priority score = Payoff minus Effort.

4 Rank your top 3

Sort by priority score. Ties go to the task that annoys you most — motivation is fuel.

Do this: Write your top 3 at the bottom of the worksheet.

5 Pressure-test #1 with AI itself

Before building anything, paste the Deep-Dive Prompt from page 4 into ChatGPT or Claude. It will map the exact tools and steps — and warn you about gotchas.

Do this: Run the prompt, read the plan, book 30 minutes to start this week.

COMMON MISTAKES

This is where most business owners get stuck.

They start with the coolest idea instead of the highest score. They pick a task with no rules and blame the AI when it fails. And they try to automate all three at once — one win first, then compound.

PRO TIP

Ask your team: "What task would you celebrate never doing again?" Their answer is usually a filter-passing goldmine — and automating it buys you instant buy-in for everything AI you do next.

The filter, the worksheet, the deep-dive prompt

The Opportunity Worksheet R = Repeated · Ru = Rules · H = 2+ Hrs/wk

TASK	R	RU	H	PAYOFF 1-5	EFFORT 1-5	SCORE
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___
_____	☐	☐	☐	___	___	___

My top 3: 1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____

Where to look first (steal these)

- ✓ **Inbox:** answering the same questions, sending the same follow-ups
- ✓ **Sales:** quotes, proposals, and "just checking in" messages
- ✓ **Admin:** scheduling, invoicing reminders, data entry between apps
- ✓ **Marketing:** turning one piece of content into five, review replies
- ✓ **Onboarding:** welcome emails, intake forms, kickoff checklists

The Deep-Dive Prompt

You are an automation consultant for small service businesses. My business: [WHAT YOU DO]. I want to automate: [YOUR #1 TASK]. Today it works like this: [DESCRIBE THE STEPS]. It takes [HOURS] hours per week. Give me: 1) the simplest way to automate it with AI, 2) the exact tools (cheapest first), 3) a beginner setup plan for this week, 4) the one step that should stay human, 5) how I'll know it's working after 30 days.

Turn this guide into one win this week.

A guide you read changes nothing. A page you fill in does. Two minutes — do it while it's fresh.

1 • WHERE I AM TODAY

My #1 AI opportunity: _____ Priority score: _____

2 • THE ONE THING I'M FIXING THIS WEEK

My one fix: _____

The first small step (under 15 minutes): _____

Small beats big. Pick something you can finish in one sitting.

3 • WHEN I'M DOING IT

Day: _____ Time: _____ Booked in my calendar? ☐

Open your calendar and book it now — a plan without a time slot is a wish.

4 • AFTER — WHAT HAPPENED

My result (hours saved, jobs booked, thing shipped): _____

What I'll do differently next time: _____

NOTES

KEEP THE STREAK

One fix a week is 52 upgrades a year. When this page is full, re-take the guide — a rising score is proof your systems are working.